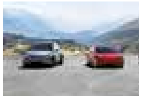
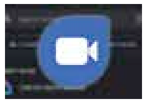
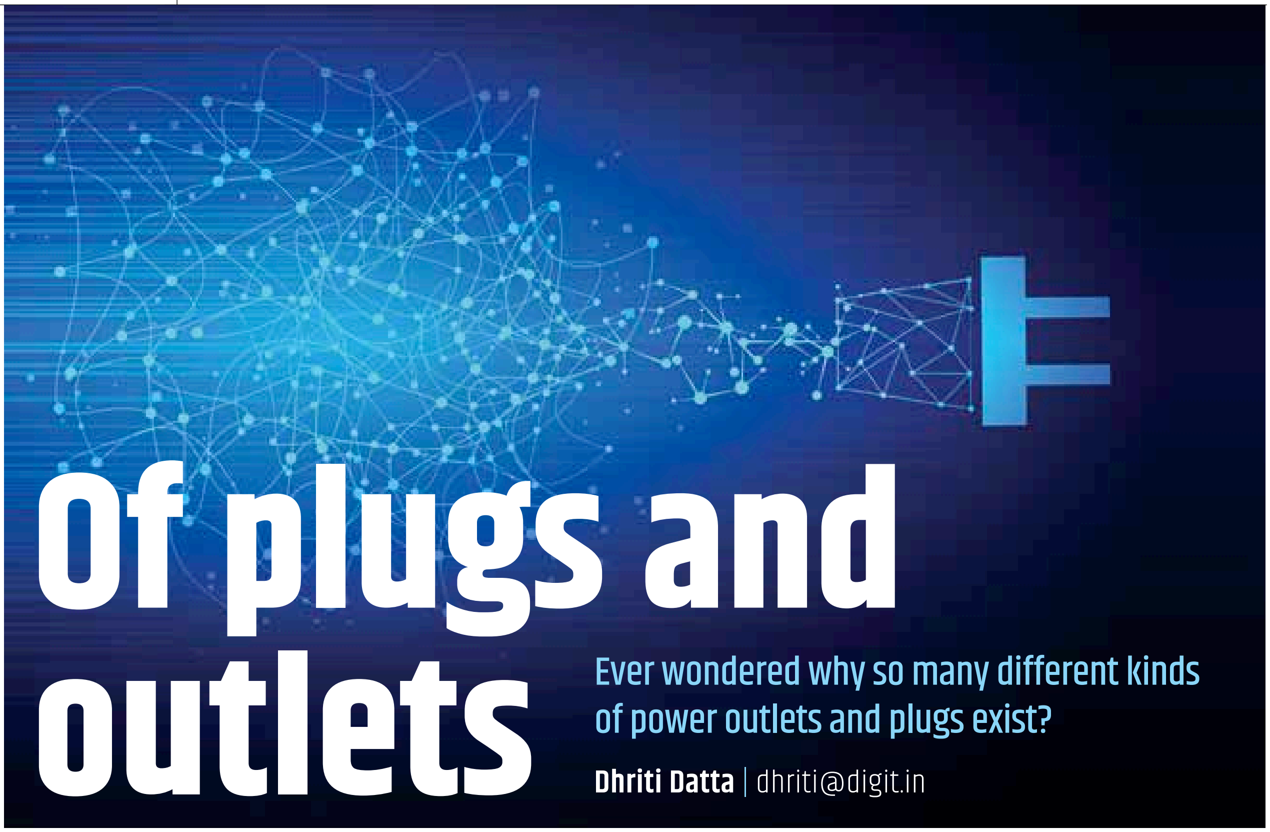


Tesla eyeing stake in LG
Tesla is eyeing stake in LG's battery business, which could secure its supply of batteries. **http://dgit.in/oct20-17**



Google Duo screen sharing
Google Duo have finally rolled out screen sharing, and here's how it works. **http://dgit.in/oct20-18**



Of plugs and outlets

Ever wondered why so many different kinds of power outlets and plugs exist?

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Travelling abroad across a bunch of countries is always appealing until you have to spend a bunch of money on different types of electrical adapters and transformers... which is not so fun. You may have heard repeated complaints of people blowing sockets out when they go overseas just because power outlets and plugs aren't standardised. The more you think about the absurd number of plugs and outlets in the world, the more outrageous it seems. In a sense, they've almost become part of a country's culture, something you must accept when you're there. There are around 12 major plug types in use today, and sockets are divided into two major groups – the 110-120V ones (usually found in North America) and the 220-240V plugs (used by most other countries). So, how did this seemingly chaotic system come into place? The short story? Individual regions independently chose to develop their own standard, before a universal standard ever had the chance to come into place. The long story? Let's delve into that.

TURBULENT BEGINNINGS

The story begins in the late 1800s, with Thomas Edison, who was the first person to harness current electricity to provide energy to households at an affordable price. After inventing a more efficient light bulb which lasted for a longer time than lightbulbs at that time that burned out after merely minutes, Edison started the first electric station, the Pearl St. Plant in NYC, to generate the electricity for his bulbs. He provided electricity via direct current (DC) at 110 volts which suffered from a tendency to lose voltage over long distances. The resistance of the wire used caused a voltage drop which increased in conjunction with increasing distance. Nevertheless, direct currents became successful and was used across households, until a newer, more efficient solution emerged.

Nikola Tesla, who briefly worked with Edison, patented a system for alternating currents in 1887 (AC) which produced voltage in cycles and essentially solved the distance problem that direct currents faced. Additionally, direct currents also required more power plants than Tesla's economical and space-conserving alternative currents. Now Tesla's 240V AC power was in direct competition with Edison's technology. Edison, however, didn't accept the technology and rather, believed them to be dangerous. He even went as far as killing dogs with AC to prove its threatening nature to win the 'War of the Currents'. Eventually, countries across the globe came to the conclusion that AC was the more superior option, and while both were used, alternating current became more embraced globally.

George Westington, the owner of Westington Electric, saw the merits of Tesla's innovation and bought his patents and even hired him eventually. Direct current saw a drop in adoption after Tesla used turbines to harness the mechanical power of Niagara Falls into AC and provided electricity to cities even a few hundred miles away.